EG Indonesia QUICKTAKE: Bank Indonesia governor's exit fuels central bank independence concerns

送信者: EG Southeast Asia 受信日時: 2026-07-27 18:08

【メール原文】

Indonesia QuickTake

27 Jul 2026 05:07 EDT

Bank Indonesia governor's exit fuels central bank independence concerns

Short-term trajectory:

Long-term trajectory:

What happened:

Bank Indonesia (BI) Governor Perry Warjiyo's resignation was announced today, with personal reasons cited—making Perry the first central bank head to leave mid-term (due to end 2028) since 2009. Senior Deputy Governor Destry Damayanti will serve as acting governor until a permanent replacement is appointed.

Our take:

Perry's departure exacerbates concerns about institutional quality and independence. Recent weeks have seen growing speculation about the futures of Perry and Minister of Finance Purbaya Yudhi Sadewa—and a souring relationship between the two—following months of heightened financial market volatility. It is unclear if the governor was pushed or left on his own accord.

As previously noted, the central bank has come under increasing political pressure since populist President Prabowo Subianto took office in 2024, but it has largely been given leeway to more hawkishly defend the rupiah—it has hiked rates 100 basis points since May. Contacts suggest, though, that there have been growing tensions between Perry and the administration plus its parliamentary allies over the balance between rate hikes and other measures to support the currency.

Notably, Perry's resignation came less than a week after BI surprised markets by holding interest rates at 5.75%; the central bank stated it could use other measures to support the currency but did not rule out further rate hikes. In June, parliament passed a revised financial omnibus bill that tweaked BI's mandate to emphasize supporting growth more and introduced vague "performance reviews" for senior central bank officials.

Destry seen as safe pair of hands, though lacks Perry's international stature. Destry's permanent appointment is plausible, especially if seen as the best way to calm markets. She has been at BI since 2019 and is a former commissioner of Indonesia Deposit Insurance Corporation and chief economist at Bank Mandiri. Destry will offer broad continuity but could possibly be (even) more susceptible to political pressure—such as to prioritize other foreign exchange measures to support the currency—than Perry, especially as she seeks support to assume the role on a permanent basis. Rate hikes could still be on the table if the currency weakens further, though. Senior BI officials previously told Eurasia Group that they believe the rupiah is undervalued but do not necessarily have a fixed view on the "right" level.

The law governing the central bank mandates an interim governor be appointed while the president nominates candidates for parliamentary approval. Destry's temporary position, therefore, does not necessarily mean the administration was caught off-guard by Perry's departure or that she is out of the running for the permanent role. The timeline for the permanent appointment is unclear.

Alternatively, the administration may turn to a technocratic economist (several options). Purbaya has been angling for the BI governor role, but that would worsen uncertainty by creating another key vacancy to fill at a crucial time. Appointing Deputy Governor Thomas Djiwandono, the president's nephew, would likely exacerbate perceptions of political interference, especially at this juncture.

EG Southeast Asia

southeastasia@eurasiagroup.net

Peter Mumford

Practice Head, Southeast Asia

+65 6653.4316

mumford@eurasiagroup.net

Olga Letticia

Associate, Southeast Asia

letticia.ne@eurasiagroup.net

Explanation of Political Trajectories (ie, "Trajectories")

Eurasia Group's (EG) Political Trajectories are indicators of the net impact of political factors on the macro business environment in a country over specific timeframes. For each country, two Trajectories are provided, a short-term (6 months) and a long term assessment (24 months). Trajectories are assigned by Eurasia Group's country analysts through a structured qualitative process. Each Trajectory represents a net assessment, indicating how political changes in a country impact the macro business environment, defined as the economic and investment climate in the country. Once initiated, Trajectories are updated both periodically and as events warrant. Trajectories may be suspended from time to time if there is no active analyst opinion or analyst coverage, but the opinion or coverage is expected to resume. Trajectories can be:

Positive: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a positive impact on the macro business environment

Neutral: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a neutral or negligible impact on the macro business environment

Negative: Political factors in the country are anticipated to have a negative impact on the macro business environment

Disclaimers: Trajectories are solely for informational purposes and should not be relied upon as investment advice. Trajectories do not indicate asset price movements, and have no value in forecasting market prices. Trajectories are based on data and analysis we deem to be reliable; they are not guaranteed as to accuracy or completeness. The Trajectories indicate the political outlook in a single country, over time. Trajectories do not address sector-specific or city/regional political risks that are often different than the country-level outlook. Trajectories represent an analyst's net qualitative assessment of a country's political outlook. EG sales, analytic staff and products may provide analysis reflecting different opinions than those expressed by the Trajectories.

X-WF-DocID wfpub_eurasia_26966_b51f2c58